MUSIC

Festival SPIRIT

AFTER A COUPLE OF FALLOW YEARS, MUSIC FESTIVALS RETURN TO INDIA WITH A VENGEANCE, BIGGER IN SCALE, GRANDER IN VISION. HERE'S A LIST OF A HANDFUL OF THEM, WITH PLENTY MORE IN THE PIPELINE AS THE ANNOUNCEMENTS POUR IN



GETTY IMAGES

Lollapalooza

January 28-29, Mumbai

The big one. Lollapalooza began in the early '90s as a goodbye tour for American alt-rockers Jane's Addiction. Today, it's a colossal worldwide festival that is making its debut in India, in Mumbai in January. They have a smashing line-up, with Imagine Dragons—those same guys who made 'Radioactive Power' song with Kanye West—and American indie-rock sensations of the early 2000s, the Strokes, headlining. It's a diverse roster of artists, as A.P. Dhillon, Diplo, Prateek Kuhad, Divine, Cigarettes After Sex, Japanese Breakfast, all take the stage across its two days. We say this about every festival, but: could this be the festival that opens India up as a viable touring destination for the super big international pop/rockstars?



International Jazz Weekend - Skinny Mo's Club

December 10-11, Kolkata

For the International Jazz Weekend later this month, a collection of virtuosic jazz and experimental musicians will be descending upon the City of Joy. Bringing together the musical idioms of Indian classical music and avant jazz, Xander Taylor takes the stage in a trio setup. The EPO Trio brings their innovative approach to the geometry of music, tackling melody versus the rhythmic interplay in music, or the role of improv set against written-out music. (Watch out for their polyrhythmic stuff, which is when two separate time signatures work together simultaneously, even when they have no right to.) Further, there will be some minimal jazz chamber music on display as HI5 take the stage, infusing their compositions with a spontaneous improv spirit.

MULTIMEDIA

BACK TO THE FUTURE

Elsewhere in India, a new live transmedia performance, finds hope even in dystopias

What do you get when you take a vision of steam-punk post-apocalypse and run it through machine-learning algorithms primed with South Indian history and aesthetics? What if all this is soundtracked by the digital avatars of two veteran electronica pioneers whose bass and techno creations are built upon wide-ranging collaborations with folk and classical musicians, in an intricate lattice-work of tradition and futuristic modernity? Assemble all these ingredients under the watchful eye of a celebrated Bharatanatyam exponent with a sideline in transmedia design, and you get something like *Elsewhere in India*, the groundbreaking live transmedia performance set to make its debut at the Magnetic Fields festival in Rajasthan this weekend.

The project is the brainchild of Avinash Kumar (Thiruda) and Sri Rama Murthy (Murthovic) who—along with Kumar's mother, Bharatanatyam artist Jayalakshmi Eshwar—make up the transmedia collective Antariksha Studios. Brought together by their mutual love for electronic music and South Indian culture, Kumar and Murthy



